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Cyber Technology Risk Lead (Effectiveness & Engagement)

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 26th October 2026



Government
Digital Service

Reference number

484405

Salary

£57,350 - £73,370

£62,120 - £73,370 (London) & £57,350 - £68,600 (Bristol & Manchester)
Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £61,620 for London and

£56,850 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Government Cyber Unit

Type of role

Digital
Security

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

As the Government Cyber Unit, our mission is to protect public services and the wider Government from cyber threats by setting strategic direction, managing programmes that implement the strategy across central government, establishing standards and policies, supporting secure digital service delivery, assuring cyber security, and leading operational response to threats, vulnerabilities and incidents.

The risks facing government and the public sector mirror the scale and complexity of government. Some risks exist in aggregate across government and need active management to stop them impacting multiple areas or becoming a national security issue.

This role is pivotal in defining and implementing a cross-government approach to address these challenges, strengthening our ability to manage and respond to complex technology risks across our organisation and government.

We're part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

You will be joining the Technology Risk team, part of the Cyber Accountability Deputy Director area, helping to drive consistent, effective technology risk management across government. The Technology Risk team works across central teams and departments to improve how technology risks are identified, understood and acted on using frameworks, data and targeted engagement to drive accountability and investment.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation's highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need.

Job description

Former DSIT recruitment campaigns are continuing as usual, but candidates should be aware that following the [Government s announcement](#) on the changes to some civil service departments, roles will be subject to the machinery of government moves and will ultimately be in one of the new departments. We will provide more information if you are selected for a role. This work remains of high importance to the civil service, and we thank you for your continued interest.

As a Cyber Technology Risk Lead (Effectiveness & Engagement) you ll:

Departmental Capability Building: design and run a structured, repeatable engagement programme with departments, targeted where the risk and the need are greatest, building the trust needed for departments to tell us what is really happening

Testing Effectiveness: form and evidence a view on whether technology risk controls across government are working, and whether the central picture of risk reflects reality in departments. Report honestly where the framework, the risk appetite or the reported position does not hold up

Framework & Appetite in Practice: drive practical adoption of the Technology Risk Framework and risk appetite, helping departments apply them proportionately in their own environments and embed them in local decisions and investment

Controls & Remediation: support departments to identify proportionate controls, risk treatments and remediation, and to prioritise action on the basis of risk, working alongside the emerging control library and GovAssure activity

Challenging the Model: use what you see on the ground to test the risk universe, severity judgements and hazard assumptions, feeding practical evidence back to the Systemic Risk Lead and the Governance & Reporting Lead, and improving the quality of departmental inputs into the central aggregation model

Thematic Guidance: create and share accessible guidance and peer learning on priority themes such as legacy IT, digital resilience, supply chain, post quantum cryptography and AI adoption, pitched at different levels of maturity and complementing, not duplicating, NCSC and other cross government guidance

Cross-Government Coordination: work with GCU Partnering, NCSC, the Assurance team and wider resilience partners so technology risk is embedded in departmental decision making and portfolio planning, using assurance outputs rather than running a parallel assurance regime

Person specification

We're interested in people who have:

experience gathering evidence and forming an independent, defensible judgement on how well risks and controls are being managed in organisations you do not directly control

experience designing proportionate evidence and reporting approaches that get a credible picture without overburdening the organisations providing it, using data and insights from a range of relevant sources to monitor maturity and control effectiveness over time

strong understanding of organisational risk appetite, risk assessment and risk treatment, including proportionate controls and remediation, and the ability to interpret risk in relation to corporate governance, strategic direction and planning

confident influencing, advising and building consensus with senior stakeholders, including boards and executive teams as well as the ability to communicate uncomfortable findings clearly while maintaining the working relationship

experience building risk, security or technology capability across organisational boundaries, designing and delivering engagement or improvement programmes that champion protective security and change how others manage risk in practice

experience translating frameworks, policy or guidance into practical, usable products tailored to different levels of maturity

understanding of digital service delivery challenges including legacy systems, resilience and technical debt, how security measures might impact on users or business needs, and of emerging risks such as supply chain vulnerabilities, post quantum cryptography and AI adoption

understanding of the current threat landscape and the ability to communicate tailored, threat informed risk information to a range of audiences

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at DSIT, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King's birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to DSIT from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

Office attendance

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from

your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at DSIT consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

- a 60 minute video interview

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is: **experience gathering evidence and forming an independent, defensible judgement on how well risks and controls are being managed in organisations you do not directly control**

In the Civil Service, we use [Success Profiles](#) to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following [Civil Service Behaviours](#):

- working together
- changing and improving
- making effective decisions
- communicating and influencing

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Lead cyber security governance and risk manager role:

- Applied security capability
- Information risk assessment and risk management
- Protective security
- Threat understanding

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? [Click Here](#)

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: 2/11/2026

Panel interviews: starting from 9/11/2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and [the Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service
Commission

